

CRC Cyber Lab

[CMMC Level 1 Media Protection \(MP\) Labs — Student Completion Guide](#)

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CMMC Level 1 Media Protection (MP) Labs — Student Completion Guide

This guide provides step-by-step instructions for completing all 3 Media Protection labs. Each lab presents a real-world scenario involving removable media that contains Federal Contract Information (FCI): classifying it, sanitizing it for reuse, and deciding the correct disposition for end-of-life equipment.

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Before You Begin

What You Need

- Your **Pod number** (your instructor will assign this, e.g., Pod01, Pod05, Pod12)
- Your **Guacamole login credentials** — your username and lab password are shown in the portal at <https://my.digitalrcc.com> under **Start Here → Lab Access**
- A computer with a web browser (Chrome, Firefox, or Edge) — no special software needed

What You Will Be Doing

In these labs you will work with **simulated removable media**. Each "USB drive" is a virtual disk file (.vhd_x) in your pod folder, and a contents listing published next to it shows everything on that drive. You will inspect what is on the media, decide whether it contains FCI, sanitize media so it can be safely reused, and complete the paperwork (logs, certificates, worksheets) that an assessor would ask to see.

The key lesson of this family: deleting files is not sanitization — media must be classified, sanitized by an approved method, and documented before it is reused or disposed of.

CMMC Context

These labs align with **CMMC Level 1 Media Protection (MP)** requirements:

- **MP.L1-3.8.3** — Sanitize or destroy information system media containing Federal Contract Information before disposal or release for reuse

They also reinforce **ACS-POL-MP-001** (the company media handling policy referenced in your artifacts) and the media inventory/classification practices that support it.

How to Connect to the Lab Environment

You will connect to the lab through **Apache Guacamole** — a web-based remote desktop gateway. There is nothing to install; everything runs in your web browser.

Step 1: Open the Guacamole Gateway

1. Open your web browser (Chrome, Firefox, or Edge)
2. Go to: <https://guac.01.digitalrcc.com/#/>
3. You will see a login screen

Step 2: Log In with Your Student Credentials

1. Enter your **Username** — this matches your pod number:
 - Pod 01 → `student01`
 - Pod 05 → `student05`
 - Pod 12 → `student12`
 - (and so on — the number matches your assigned pod)
2. Enter your **Password** — sign in to the portal at <https://my.digitalrcc.com>, open **Start Here**, and under **Lab Access** click **Show my lab password**
3. Click **Login**

Step 3: Connect to Your Pod Server

Connection Name	What It Is
PODXX-SRV	Your pod server — use this for all MP labs

This is the only connection you get: every MP lab is done on this desktop. The server is joined to the `acs-p01.local` domain, so you never sign in to a domain controller.

1. Click on **PODXX-SRV** (where XX is your pod number, e.g., **POD03-SRV**)
2. The remote desktop session opens directly in your browser — no extra login is needed
3. Wait a few seconds for the Windows Server desktop to appear

Tip: Press **Ctrl+Alt+Shift** to open the Guacamole side menu (to return Home or switch connections).

Step 4: Check Your Lab Progress

Option 1: Click the "Check Your Progress — Pod XX" banner at the top of the Guacamole interface.

Option 2: Go directly to <https://training.digitalrcc.com/pod/XX> (replace XX with your pod number).

How to Open Your Lab Artifacts

1. Open **File Explorer** on the server desktop (folder icon on the taskbar, or **Windows + E**)
2. Navigate to: **C:\CyberLab\PodXX\MP-Artifacts** (e.g., **C:\CyberLab\Pod03\MP-Artifacts**)

Alternative method using PowerShell:

1. Press **Windows key + R**, type `powershell`, press Enter
2. Run: `explorer "C:\CyberLab\Pod03\MP-Artifacts"` (replace `03` with your pod number)

What You Will See

File names use your own pod prefix, not PXX. PXX is a placeholder for your pod prefix throughout this guide: Pod 07 sees `P07-FCI-USB-Contents.txt`, Pod 03 sees `P03-FCI-USB-Contents.txt`. There is no file literally named `PXX-...`, so if a file in the list below appears to be missing, look for the same name with your prefix.

File	What It Is
<code>MP-Lab-Instructions.txt</code>	Short summary of all three labs
<code>PXX-FCI-USB.vhdx</code>	Simulated USB drive that contains contract data
<code>PXX-Employee-Handbook.vhdx</code>	Simulated USB drive with general company documents
<code>PXX-FCI-USB-Contents.txt</code> , <code>PXX-Employee-Handbook-Contents.txt</code>	Full contents listing of each drive, including hidden items — read these instead of mounting (Pod 07: <code>P07-FCI-USB-Contents.txt</code>)
<code>MediaInventory.xlsx</code>	Media inventory spreadsheet

File	What It Is
MediaClassificationWorksheet.docx	Worksheet you fill in for M1-L1
MediaClassificationResponses.csv	Your graded answer file for M1-L1
MediaDisposalPolicy.pdf	Policy reference (ACS-POL-MP-001)
MediaSanitizationLog.csv	Graded answer file for M1-L2
MediaSanitizationCertificate.csv	Graded answer file for M1-L2
MP-M1-L2_SeedMetadata.json	Do not edit or delete
LaptopAssetRecord.csv, ChainOfCustody.csv, VendorDestructionCertificate.txt	Evidence for M1-L3
MP-M1-L3_DispositionWorksheet.csv	Graded answer file for M1-L3
_LAB_READY_MP-M1-*.txt	Markers confirming the lab was seeded

Important: Do not delete the original evidence files or the `_LAB_READY_ / SeedMetadata` files. Fill in the CSV answer files in place (the checker reads those exact file names).

Editing the CSV Answer Files

The graded answer files are CSVs with the header row and blank cells already in place. Either:

- Open them with **Notepad** (right-click → Open with → Notepad) and type your values between the commas, or
- Open them with **Excel**, fill the cells, then **Save as CSV** (keep the same file name and `.csv` type)

Do not rename the columns, and do not add extra header rows.

Understanding Your Pod

Everything in your pod is prefixed with your pod number so your work stays separate from other students. If you are **Pod 03**, your prefix is **P03**:

- Artifacts folder: `C:\CyberLab\Pod03\MP-Artifacts\`
- FCI media: `P03-FCI-USB.vhdx` (media ID `P03-FCI-USB`)
- General media: `P03-Employee-Handbook.vhdx`
- End-of-life laptop: `P03-LAP-017`, drive serial `SN-P03-88421`
- Vendor destruction certificate: `VDC-P03-2026-017`

Throughout this guide, replace **XX** with your pod number and **PXX** with your pod prefix.

Working With the Lab Media (VHDX Files)

A `.vhdx` file behaves like a physical USB drive. Mounting one is an administrator operation on Windows, and on this shared server student accounts are deliberately not administrators — so for this cohort **you do not mount the media yourself**. Each drive image ships with a full contents listing that was captured from the mounted media, and you classify and document from that.

Read what is on a drive

1. In File Explorer, open `C:\CyberLab\PodXX\MP-Artifacts\`
2. Open the listing next to the drive image (with your pod prefix in place of `PXX`):
 - `PXX-FCI-USB-Contents.txt`
 - `PXX-Employee-Handbook-Contents.txt`
3. Each listing shows the volume label and **every** file and folder on that drive — including hidden items — with sizes

Or in PowerShell:

```
Get-Content C:\CyberLab\PodXX\MP-Artifacts\PXX-FCI-USB-Contents.txt
```

If you try to mount a `.vhdx` you will get "A required privilege is not held by the client", or Windows will ask for administrator credentials that your account does not have. That is expected — use the contents listing instead. Nothing is broken and no lab credit depends on mounting.

Module 1: Media Protection

Lab M1-L1: Classify the Media

Difficulty: Beginner | **Time:** 25 minutes | **Type:** Media inspection + worksheet

Scenario

Two USB drives were found in an unlocked desk drawer at ACS Consulting. Before either one can be reused, stored, or thrown away, you must determine whether it holds Federal Contract Information. FCI is information provided by or generated for the government under a contract that is **not** intended for public release.

What You Need

- `PXX-FCI-USB.vhdx`
- `PXX-Employee-Handbook.vhdx`

- MediaInventory.xlsx, MediaClassificationWorksheet.docx, MediaDisposalPolicy.pdf
- Answer file: MediaClassificationResponses.csv

Steps

1. Read the policy first:

- Open MediaDisposalPolicy.pdf and note how the policy defines FCI and what handling it requires

2. Inspect the first drive:

- Open PXX-FCI-USB-Contents.txt
- Read every folder listed: Contracts, Purchase Orders, Drawings, Invoices, General Office, and the hidden Hidden Archive and Temp folders
- Look for file names referencing the federal contract FA-2026-PXX
- Note that some FCI is in hidden folders or a temp file. Media is classified by the **most sensitive** thing on it, so one contract file is enough to make the whole drive FCI

3. Inspect the second drive:

- Open PXX-Employee-Handbook-Contents.txt
- Review Policies\Employee-Handbook.txt, Benefits\Benefits-Guide.txt, General Office\Holiday-Calendar.txt
- These are internal general business documents — no contract data, no government deliverables

4. Complete the worksheet:

- Open MediaClassificationWorksheet.docx and record, for each drive, what you found and why it does or does not meet the FCI definition
- Cross-check MediaInventory.xlsx so your media IDs match the inventory

5. Record your graded answers in MediaClassificationResponses.csv:

Column	What to enter
Media	Already filled in — leave as is
Classification	FCI for the FCI drive, Non-FCI for the handbook drive
Evidence	A specific sentence naming the file(s) that justify your classification (must be more than a few words)

Example of a completed row (use your own findings):

PXX-FCI-USB.vhdx, FCI, Contracts\Federal-Services-Contract-2026.txt and Invoices\INV-2026-031.txt reference federal contract FA-2026-PXX
PXX-Employee-Handbook.vhdx, Non-FCI, Only general internal documents: employee handbook, benefits guide, holiday calendar

Completion Criteria

☐

PXX-FCI-USB.vhdx is classified as FCI

☐

PXX-Employee-Handbook.vhdx is classified as Non-FCI

☐

Both rows have specific written evidence (a short phrase is not enough)

☐

Worksheet, inventory, policy and both .vhdx files are still present in the folder

Why This Matters

You cannot protect FCI you have not identified. Media classification is the first step of MP.L1-3.8.3 — it decides which drives need sanitization or destruction later.

Lab M1-L2: Sanitize Media for Reuse

Difficulty: Intermediate | **Time:** 25 minutes | **Type:** Sanitization records

You are a local administrator on your own pod server, so you perform the sanitization yourself in step 3 and it **is** graded: the verification mounts the media and checks the label, that the volume is empty, and that it is a new volume rather than an emptied one.

Scenario

PXX-FCI-USB is being reassigned to a non-federal project team. Before release for reuse it must be sanitized in accordance with **ACS-POL-MP-001**. A previous employee "sanitized" a drive by selecting the files and pressing Delete — the data was recovered by an auditor two weeks later. You will do it properly.

What You Need

- PXX-FCI-USB-Contents.txt (what is on the media today)
- Answer files: MediaSanitizationLog.csv, MediaSanitizationCertificate.csv

Steps

1. Understand what "sanitize" means:

- **Clear** — overwrite the media so data cannot be recovered with standard tools
- **Purge** — a stronger method (e.g., degauss or cryptographic erase) that defeats laboratory recovery
- **Destroy** — physically render the media unusable (used when media will not be reused)
- Deleting files, emptying the Recycle Bin, and quick-deleting a folder are **none** of these

2. Confirm what is on the media before it is sanitized (evidence for your log):

- Open `PXX-FCI-USB-Contents.txt` and note the current volume label (`PXX-FCI-MEDIA`) and the folders present

3. Re-create the volume: delete it and create a new one, fully formatted — not merely emptied. Do this from an **elevated** session (right-click PowerShell → Run as administrator; accept the UAC prompt).

Option A — Disk Management (GUI):

- Press **Windows + R**, type `diskmgmt.msc`, press Enter
- **Action → Attach VHD**, browse to `C:\CyberLab\PodXX\MP-Artifacts\PXX-FCI-USB.vhdx`, click OK
- Find the attached disk at the bottom of the window (it will be about 96 MB)
- Right-click its partition → **Delete Volume** → Yes
- Right-click the resulting unallocated space → **New Simple Volume** → Next
- Use the full size → assign any drive letter → **Format this volume:**
 - File system: **NTFS**
 - Volume label: **PXX-SANITIZED** (exactly this, with your pod prefix)
 - **Uncheck** "Perform a quick format" (a full format overwrites the data area)
- Finish and wait for the format to complete
- Right-click the disk (left-hand grey box) → **Detach VHD**

Option B — PowerShell:

```

$vhd = "C:\CyberLab\PodXX\MP-Artifacts\PXX-FCI-USB.vhdx"

Mount-DiskImage -ImagePath $vhd
$disk = Get-DiskImage -ImagePath $vhd | Get-Disk

# Remove the old volume and create a brand-new one
Clear-Disk -Number $disk.Number -RemoveData -Confirm:$false
Initialize-Disk -Number $disk.Number -PartitionStyle MBR -ErrorAction
    SilentlyContinue
$part = New-Partition -DiskNumber $disk.Number -UseMaximumSize -AssignDriveLetter
Format-Volume -Partition $part -FileSystem NTFS -NewFileSystemLabel "PXX-
    SANITIZED" -Full -Confirm:$false

# Confirm the volume is empty
Get-ChildItem -Path "$($part.DriveLetter):\\" -Force

Dismount-DiskImage -ImagePath $vhd

```

(Replace PodXX / PXX with your pod values. -Full performs the overwriting format.)

4. **Validate your own work:** the label reads PXX-SANITIZED and the volume is empty apart from System Volume Information and \$RECYCLE.BIN. Dismount the image when you are finished — leaving it attached does not fail the check, but the drive letter stays in use.
5. **Complete MediaSanitizationLog.csv and MediaSanitizationCertificate.csv.** Both files use the same columns and both must be filled in:

Column	What to enter
MediaId	Leave as PXX-FCI-USB
Method	Clear or Purge (the method used on this media)
Result	Pass (replace Pending)
Disposition	Reuse
SanitizedBy	Your name
Date	The date the sanitization was performed, e.g., 2026-06-10

Completion Criteria



PXX-FCI-USB.vhdx holds a **new** NTFS volume labelled PXX-SANITIZED with no files or folders left on it



Sanitization **log** and **certificate** both record Clear or Purge, Pass, Reuse, a SanitizedBy name, and a valid date



MP-M1-L2_SeedMetadata.json is still present and unmodified

Why This Matters

MP.L1-3.8.3 requires sanitization **before** media is released for reuse. Deleted files remain recoverable, so an assessor tests the media and the records — which is exactly what this lab does.

Lab M1-L3: Decide the Disposition

Difficulty: Intermediate | **Time:** 25 minutes | **Type:** Document analysis + worksheet

Scenario

Laptop PXX-LAP-017 from the Federal Programs group has failed diagnostics and reached end of life. Its drive held FCI. Facilities has already sent it out with a chain-of-custody record, and the vendor returned a certificate. Your job is to record the correct disposition decision and prove that the paperwork lines up.

What You Need

- LaptopAssetRecord.csv
- ChainOfCustody.csv
- VendorDestructionCertificate.txt
- Answer file: MP-M1-L3_DispositionWorksheet.csv

Steps

1. Read the asset record (LaptopAssetRecord.csv):

- Asset PXX-LAP-017, owner Federal Programs, status **End of life**
- ContainsFCI = **Yes**
- DriveSerial = SN-PXX-88421
- Serviceability = **Failed diagnostics**

2. Read the chain of custody (ChainOfCustody.csv):

- Record C0C-PXX-017 shows the drive released by Jordan Lee to an approved destruction vendor for the purpose of **Destruction**
- Confirm the drive serial matches the asset record

3. Read the vendor certificate (VendorDestructionCertificate.txt):

- Certificate VDC-PXX-2026-017, method **Physical shredding**, status **DESTROYED**, witnessed
- Confirm the asset ID and drive serial match

4. Reason through the decision:

- **Reuse** is wrong — the drive failed diagnostics and cannot be reliably sanitized or trusted
- **Return to inventory** is wrong — the asset is end of life and still contains FCI
- **Destroy** is correct — FCI media that will not be reused must be destroyed, and the custody record and vendor certificate already document destruction

5. Complete MP-M1-L3_DispositionWorksheet.csv:

Column	What to enter
AssetId	Leave as PXX-LAP-017
Decision	Destroy
DriveSerial	SN-PXX-88421 (must match the asset and custody records)
CertificateId	VDC-PXX-2026-017 (must match the vendor certificate)
Rationale	At least a full sentence (20+ characters) explaining why destruction is required — cite the failed drive, the FCI content, and the vendor certificate

Example rationale:

Drive failed diagnostics and cannot be reliably sanitized; the asset is end of life and held FCI, so destruction was performed and documented on certificate VDC-PXX-2026-017.

Completion Criteria

☐

Decision is Destroy

☐

DriveSerial and CertificateId match the supporting records exactly

☐

Rationale is a complete justification, not a single word

☐

Asset record, chain of custody and vendor certificate are all still present

Why This Matters

MP.L1-3.8.3 gives you two valid outcomes for FCI media: sanitize it or destroy it. Choosing correctly — and being able to show matching custody and certificate records — is what turns a decision into audit evidence.

Quick Reference: Where to Find Things

Task	Where to Go
Open the artifacts folder	C:\CyberLab\PodXX\MP-Artifacts\
Read what is on simulated media	Open PXX-<name>-Contents.txt in the artifacts folder
Open PowerShell	Windows + R → powershell
Check your lab progress	https://training.digitalrcc.com/pod/XX

Media Handling Terms

Term	Meaning
FCI	Federal Contract Information — provided by or generated for the government under a contract, not for public release
Clear	Overwrite the media so standard recovery tools cannot retrieve the data
Purge	Stronger sanitization (degauss, cryptographic erase) that defeats laboratory recovery
Destroy	Physically render media unusable (shred, incinerate, disintegrate)
Chain of custody	Documented record of who held the media, when, and why

Tips and Common Mistakes

Mistake	Solution
Deleting files and calling it sanitization	Delete the volume and create a new one, then full-format it
Filling in only the sanitization log	The certificate must be completed with the same values
Leaving Result as Pending	Change it to Pass
One-word evidence or rationale	The checker requires real explanatory text
Editing or deleting MP-M1-L2_SeedMetadata.json	Leave it alone
Renaming the answer CSVs	Keep the exact file names; the checker looks for them
Missing hidden FCI in M1-L1	The contents listing includes hidden items — read Hidden Archive and Temp

Getting Unstuck

- **Asked for administrator credentials when opening a .vhdx?** Expected — cancel the prompt and read the -Contents.txt listing instead

- **Verification still failing?** Re-read the exact wording of the failure reason on your progress page and check the answer CSVs against the tables above
 - **Missing artifacts?** Ask your instructor to reseed the MP family for your pod
-

Lab Completion Checklist

Lab	Name	Status
M1-L1	Classify the Media	☐
M1-L2	Sanitize Media for Reuse	☐
M1-L3	Decide the Disposition	☐

After completing each lab:

1. Confirm your answer CSVs are saved in C:\CyberLab\PodXX\MP-Artifacts\ with their original names
 2. Confirm all seeded evidence files are still present
 3. Check your status at <https://training.digitalrcc.com/pod/XX>
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CMMC Level 1 — Media Protection (MP) Module